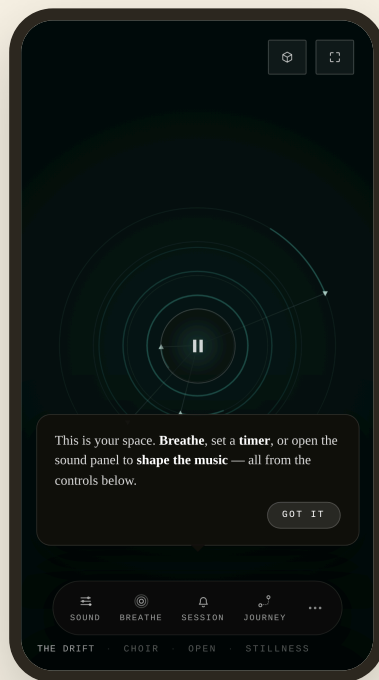


USER MANUAL

The Drift.

A generative ambient instrument that never repeats — a field guide to every feature, on your phone.

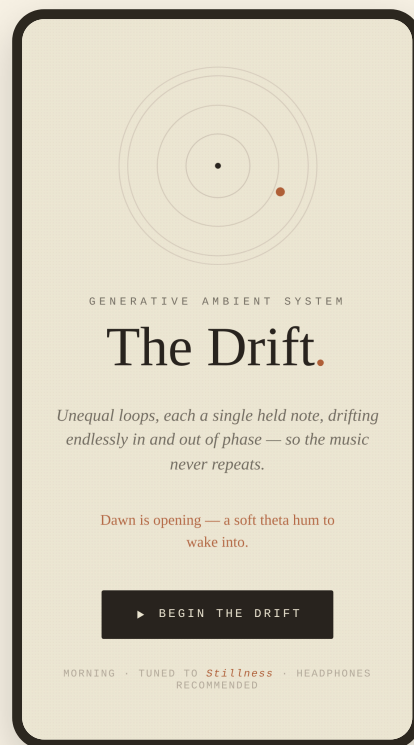


GENERATIVE AMBIENT SYSTEM · [FIDDLYDIGITAL.GITHUB.IO/THEDRIFT](https://fiddlydigital.github.io/thedrift)

1 • What The Drift is

The Drift is a generative ambient music instrument that runs entirely in your browser. It builds a piece of music from a handful of **loops** — each one a single synthesized note on its own slightly-irrational length. Because no two loops share a tidy ratio, they drift endlessly in and out of phase, so the music shifts forever and **never repeats**.

Everything is synthesized live with the Web Audio API — there are no samples, no account, and no server. It works offline and installs as an app. The whole thing is built to be calm: you land straight inside a full-screen visual and shape the sound from there.

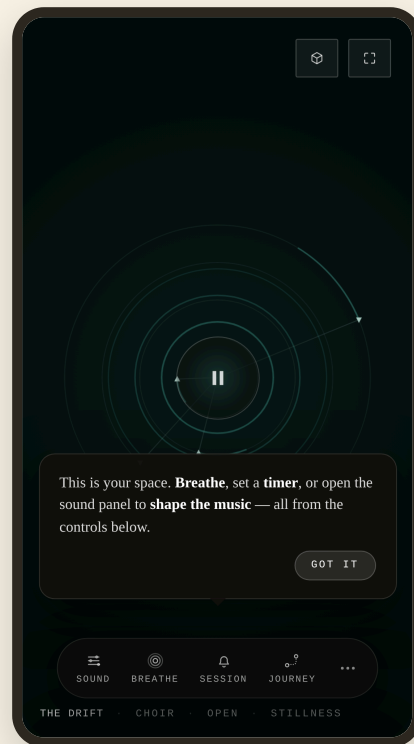


The opening splash — “Begin the drift” starts the sound

2 • Getting started

Tap **Begin the drift** on the welcome screen. That single tap both starts playback and unlocks audio (browsers require a gesture before any sound). You arrive in the **mandala** — the permanent, full-screen home of the experience.

The centre of the mandala is the **play / pause** button. A floating **dock** along the bottom is the remote for everything else. The chrome quietly fades after a few seconds of stillness and returns the moment you move or tap.

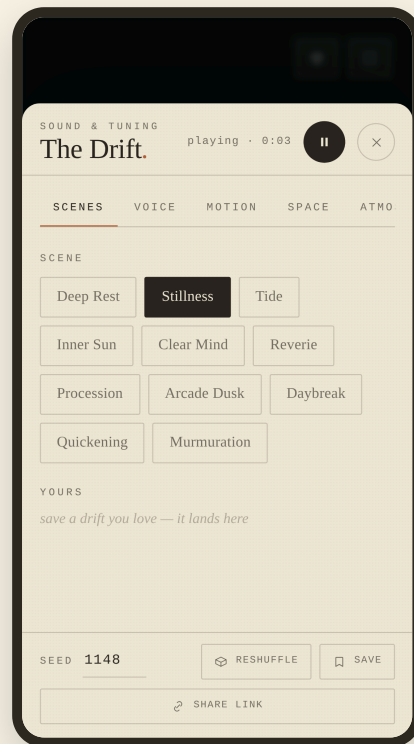


The mandala and the dock — your home base

3 • Scenes — one-tap moods

The fastest way to change the whole feel is a **Scene**. Open **Sound** from the dock and you land on the Scenes tab: eleven curated presets, ordered from calm to alert — Deep Rest, Stillness, Tide, Inner Sun, Clear Mind, Reverie, Procession, Arcade Dusk, Daybreak, Quickenings, Murmuration. One tap re-tunes every dial, instrument and texture at once.

Found something you love? **Save** it to *Yours*, or **Share link** to copy a URL that encodes the entire setup.

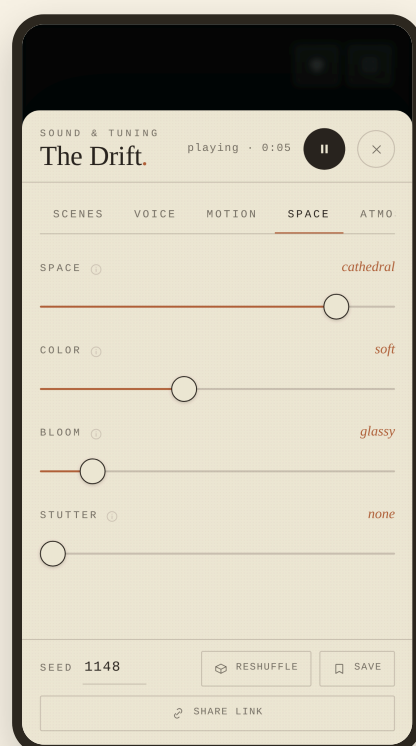


Scenes — eleven curated presets,
calm → alert

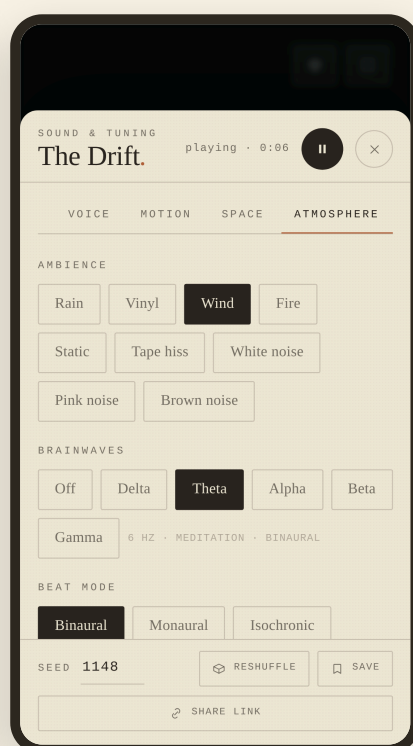
4 • Shaping the sound

The Sound & tuning console holds tabbed control groups. Every knob has a plain-language readout, so you can dial by ear:

- **Voice** — the mood (harmonic palette), the ensemble of instruments, and the tuning reference (432 Hz, 440 Hz and others).
- **Motion** — Density (how many loops), Tempo, Drift (how unequal the loops are), Register, and Evolve / Journey (how fast the field changes on its own).
- **Space** — reverb size, timbral colour, Bloom (a bell-like shimmer) and tape-stutter.
- **Atmosphere** — an ambience bed (rain, vinyl, wind, fire...) and brainwave beats (Delta → Gamma) with binaural / monaural / isochronic delivery.
- **Mixer** — Master, Loops, Ambience, Beat and Glue (compression) levels.



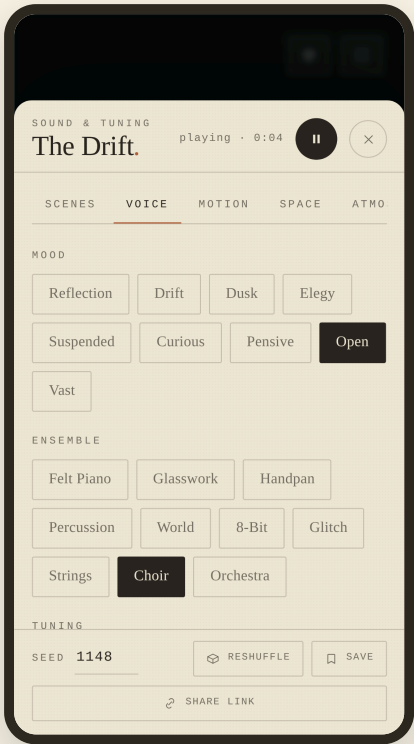
Space – reverb, colour, bloom, stutter



Atmosphere – ambience + brainwave beats

4 • Shaping the sound (continued)

Voice sets the harmonic character and the instruments; the Mixer balances the layers. None of these need headphones except the binaural beats and spatial audio, which are flagged in the interface where it matters.



Voice – mood, ensemble, tuning

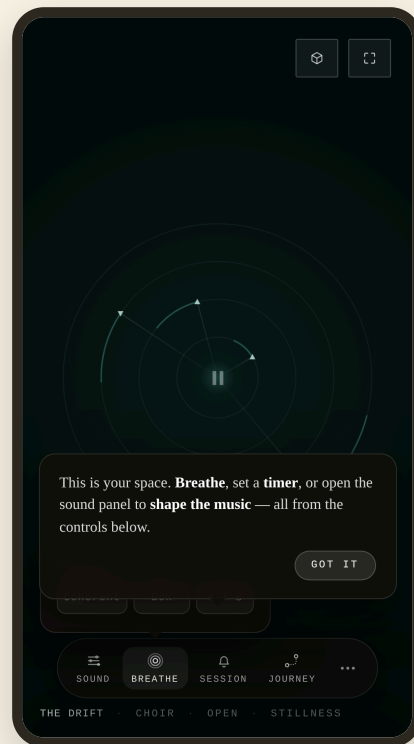


Mixer – balance the layers

5 • The breath guide

Tap **Breathe** in the dock to start an animated breathing pacer. Choose a pattern — Coherent (about 5.5 breaths a minute), Box (4-4-4-4) or 4-7-8 — and a pace. The ring expands on the inhale and settles on the exhale, in both the 2D and 3D views.

You can also let it breathe *with sound* (a soft swell on each inhale) and, on supported phones, add **haptic pacing** — a gentle buzz at each phase change so you can keep your eyes closed.

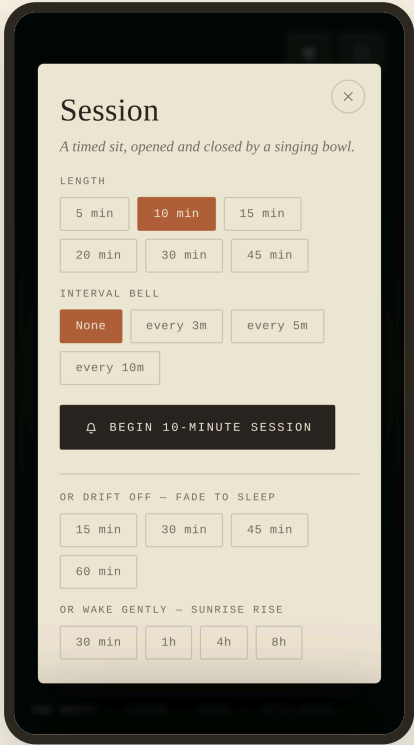


The breath guide — pattern, pace, sound & haptics

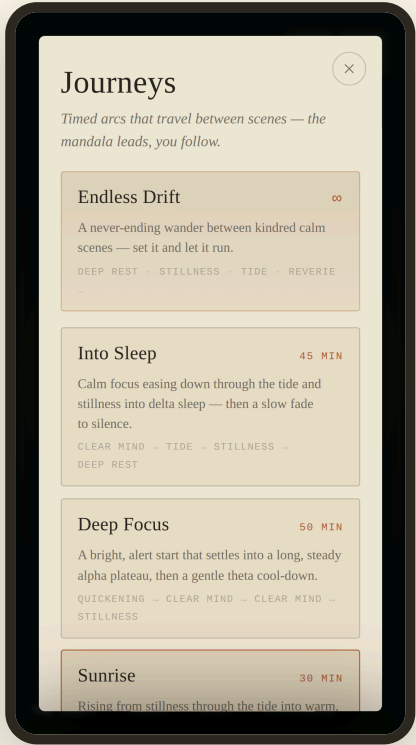
6 • Meditation & sleep tools

Session sets a timed sit — opening and closing singing-bowl bells, with optional interval bells. **Sleep** fades gently to silence after a set time, and a **Wake / sunrise** timer starts inaudible and rises slowly over up to eight hours.

Journey mode travels between scenes on a timed arc with smooth crossfades — Into Sleep, Deep Focus, Sunrise, Unwind — or an open-ended Endless Drift that simply wanders.



Session – a timed sit with bells

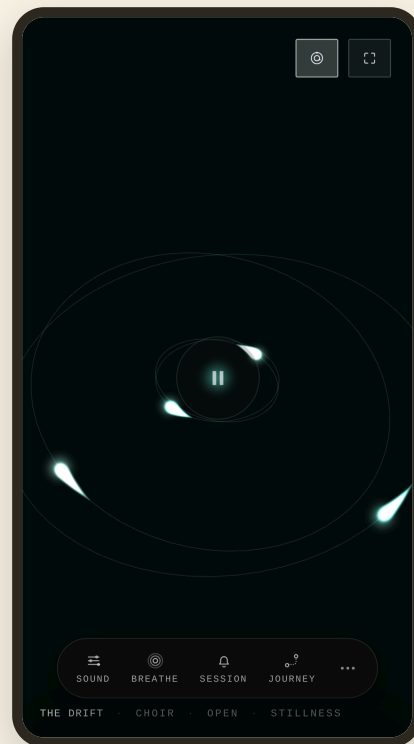


Journey – timed arcs between scenes

7 • Two ways to watch

The top-corner control flips between the **2D mandala** — rotating hands that bloom on each strike, threads lighting when loops align — and a **3D space**: a WebGL orrery where every voice is a glowing orb on its own tilted orbit, with comet trails and a central star. Drag to rotate, pinch to zoom.

With **spatial audio** on (headphones), each voice's sound is placed where its orb appears, and the soundstage follows the camera as you turn the orrery.

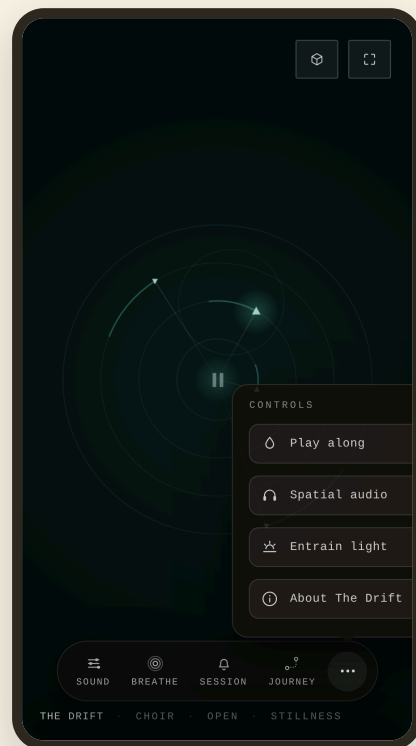


3D space — each voice an orb on
its own orbit

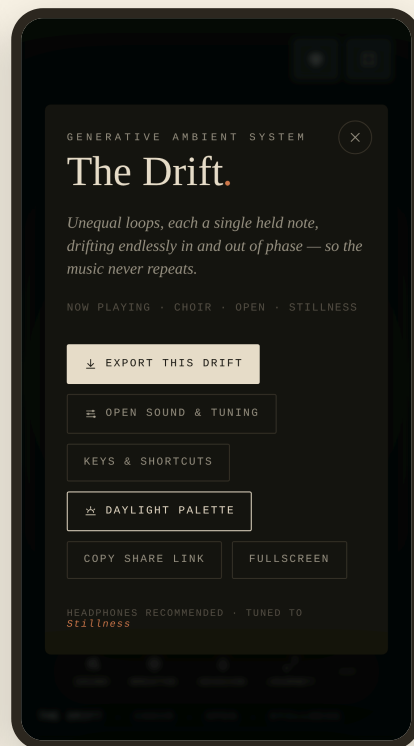
8 • Feel toggles, sharing & dark mode

The **More** menu (the ⋮ on the dock) holds the live “feel” toggles — *Play along* (tap the mandala to drop notes in key), *Spatial audio*, and *Entrain light* (the field pulses with the beat) — plus **About**.

From About you can **Export** the current drift to a WAV file (1–5 minutes, rendered offline), **copy a share link**, go fullscreen, or switch to the **Midnight palette** — a sleep-friendly dark theme for the panels and sheets.



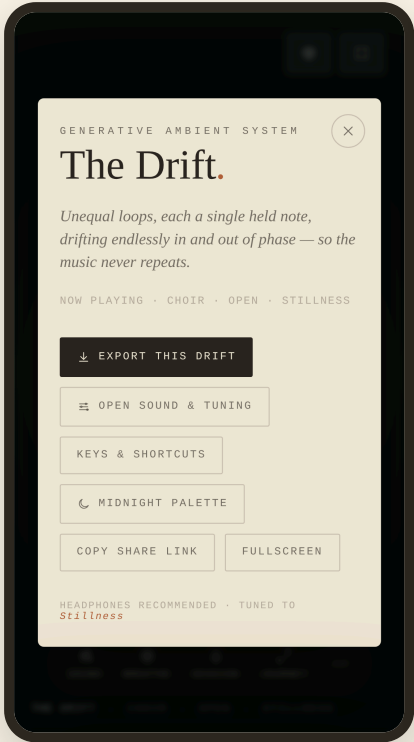
The More menu – feel toggles +
About



Midnight palette – a dark theme
for night

8 · Sharing & export (continued)

A share link rebuilds your exact setup — every dial, the seed, and any hand-authored Atelier data — for anyone who opens it. Export renders the same field deterministically to a 44.1 kHz stereo WAV you can keep.



About — export, share, fullscreen, palette



Export — render a WAV of this drift

9 · Atelier — the expert workshop

Hidden for the curious: **triple-tap the title** in the Sound panel to unlock the **Atelier**. It turns the generator into a hand-authored instrument — pick a key and one of 24 scales and toggle individual notes; build each loop’s instrument, note and length in the *Voice loom*; lock voices so they hold while the rest keep drifting; and map a MIDI controller to the dials and transport.

The Atelier also hides a pair of optional **lab scopes** — a live *spectrogram* (frequency × time) and a stereo *vectorscope* — tapped off the master output, for seeing exactly how your tweaks reshape the sound.



Atelier — hand-authoring, MIDI, and lab scopes